

KATHA STUDIO

A Wrestler's Promise

A young wrestler is offered a shortcut of trophies. The mud remembers who he promised to remain.

Issue 05 · Sports fable · Amritsar akhara

Lead: Raja Pahalwan



Original Indian c

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Panel 1 of 6



Before medals, there is mud. Before fame, there is a guru's silence.

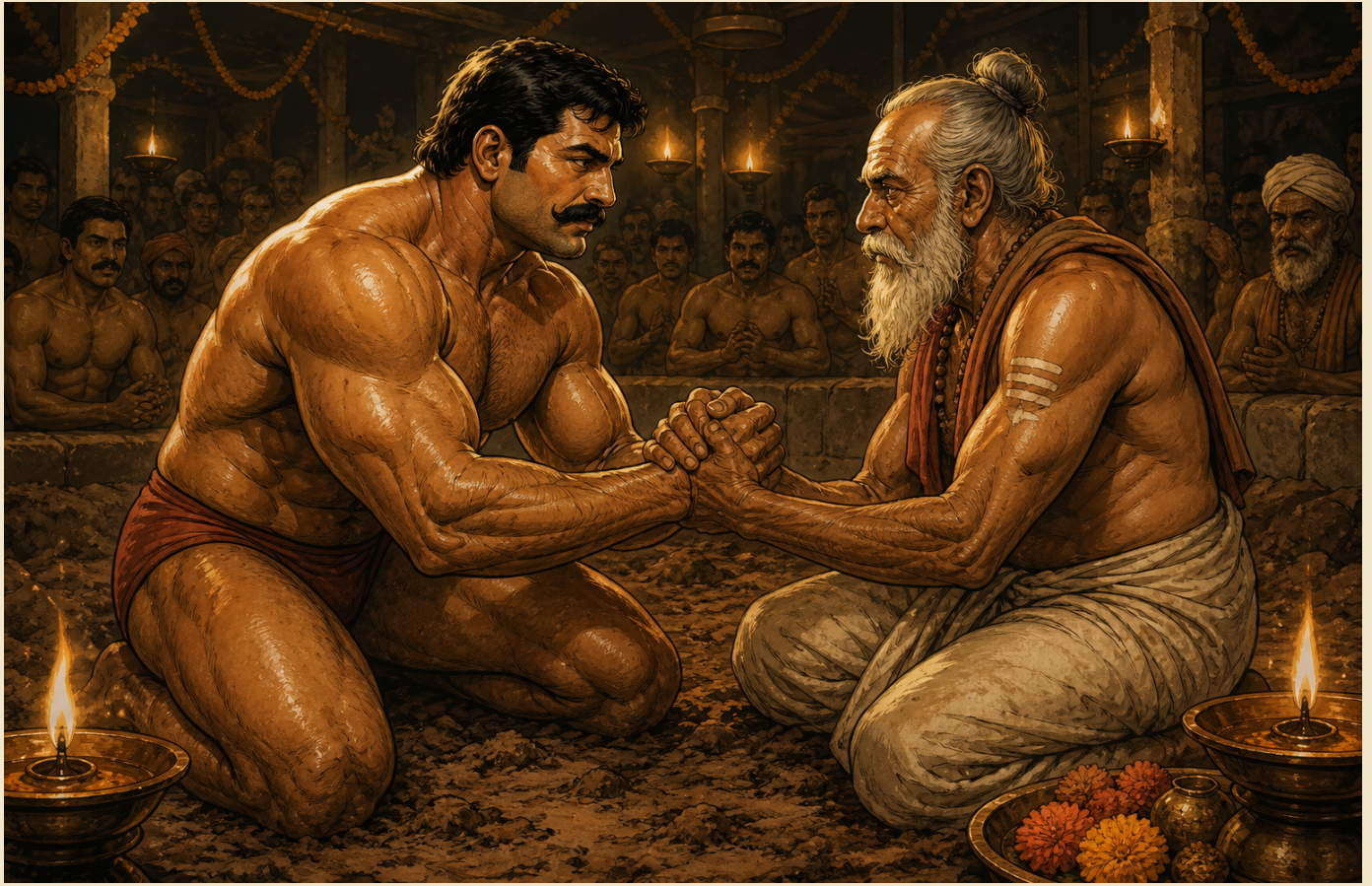
NARRATOR

“Kushti is not a sport you win. It is a habit you keep.”

THUD

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Panel 2 of 6



Guru-ji's hands are map-lines of every throw he ever taught.

GURU-JI

“Strength is cheap. Who you refuse — that is expensive.”

BREATH

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Panel 3 of 6



A promoter arrives with gold cups that clink like hollow teeth.

PROMOTER

“Throw the next three bouts as I say. The city will chant your name by Friday.”

CLINK

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Panel 4 of 6



Raja looks at the cups, then at the man who taught him to stand.

RAJA

“If the city chants a lie, it is not my name they are using.”

NO

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Panel 5 of 6



Pride arrives as a smoke-and-medal giant. Raja meets it in the pit, the only courtroom he trusts.

RAJA

“You can have the noise. I am keeping the mud.”

WHAM



Oil lamps. A bow. The rival dissolves into ordinary dust, which is all pride ever was.

GURU-JI

“Good. Tomorrow we train at four. Champions still sweep the pit.”

AMEN